

and entertainment have really picked up open source adoption.

Q. As a community leader, how do you encourage developers to adopt open source across businesses?

A. In today's business landscape, every customer demands accelerated delivery at a reduced cost, making it a critical aspect of our engagements. Failing to meet these expectations means someone else will step in. Open source allows us to lower costs, accelerate delivery, and tailor solutions to fit specific use cases to meet the fast-paced demands of the market. It also provides the flexibility for the community and users to experiment, iterate faster, and embrace agile methodologies. The third advantage stems from the democratisation of technology. In the current landscape, every company is essentially a tech company — even entities like banks today are tech companies with a banking licence. Open source becomes integral in this scenario, enabling companies to stay technologically competitive.

Q. How can the balance between data security and open source be maintained?

A. Attacks are happening faster than one can respond. How we put in the right mechanism to make open source software resilient plays a significant role in eliminating vulnerabilities before attackers can exploit them. We must have proper guardrails to manage data in transit, data in use, and data at rest. Open source never compromises on data privacy. So many techniques, cryptography, etc., can be brought into focus through open source. For instance, in the context of cloud and open source, cryptography is employed, but the efficacy of cryptographic algorithms is not foolproof. Consider a scenario where

an individual begins selling personal information online. Without proper guardrails, someone observing this activity could extract and potentially misuse that information. Collaborative efforts within the industry and the open source community, or even at an individual level, are needed to establish effective guardrails that prevent unauthorised extraction of personal information. It's important to harden your security posture, manage risk and compliance, and automate governance processes to ensure open source data security.

Q. But with the influx of information, isn't it easy to break through these guardrails?

A. Indeed, obtaining information on virtually anything has become quite effortless today. This is where responsible AI plays a crucial role — in implementing the proper guidance and mechanisms to maintain a balance. Another consideration is the ability to redact information and ensure that I have all the information while creating a bubble around it so that it is not easily accessible to any unauthorised or malicious entity. For instance, one might have various contact numbers and other details available, but it's vital to establish guidelines to prevent the disclosure of all information. The information can still be accessible, but it remains within a defined bubble, ensuring that the linkage between different pieces of information is restricted and not readily available to external entities.

Q. With the increasing reliance of Indian startups on open source systems and the community's growth, who holds the responsibility for putting up these guardrails?

A. The community is growing, and adoption is a good sign. But at the same time, it's a shared responsibility that

extends beyond mere coding, especially when placing data in the cloud or utilising open source. Simply assuming the cloud provider's systems will handle everything is not accurate. Being an equal stakeholder in managing and monitoring is very important. Sometimes, clients believe that once data is on the cloud, the cloud provider secures everything, but so many things go on within the application. Neglecting these areas compromises actual security. This is not exclusive to open source; it involves culture and mindset. Everyone, whether an individual or a company, needs to adopt the same responsibility model. We have been on a 100-year journey in open source and yet we are still at the tip of the iceberg. It will only grow; there is no finish line for open source, whether physical or technological.

Q. How does a company harness the power of open source to generate revenue?

A. Anyone can use open source technology. Take, for instance, ad-tech which is utilised to attract users. That, in itself, will generate revenue. Selection of the right open source solutions, focus on compatibility and integration, implementation of right security measures, and robust update processes need to be ingrained into business to leverage the power of open source and generate revenue. Today I can provide a differentiated value proposition to business through open source software integration.

Q. What should businesses engaging with open source prioritise – profitability or open innovation?

A. The primary focus should always be customer satisfaction, which inherently leads to financial success, regardless of the technology used. For finding the right player, open innovation opportunities are a must. Customers often appear content but are inherently dissatisfied and crave for more value. It is of paramount